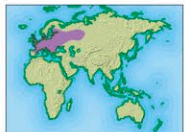


Talpa europaea

European mole



Length 4¼–6½ in
(1–16 cm)
Tail ¾ in
(2 cm)
Weight 2½–5 oz
(65–125 g)
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern

Location Europe to N. Asia

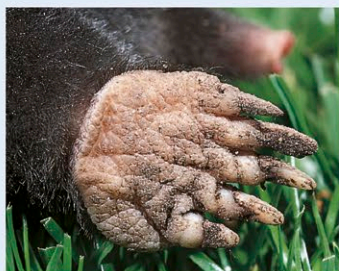


Virtually blind, this mole lives mainly underground in tunnels radiating from a central chamber, feeding on worms and other soil animals. When plentiful, the worms are bitten to paralyze them for future use, but, if uneaten, they recover and escape. The female digs a large nest chamber, and after 4 weeks' gestation, gives birth to 3–4 young.



REVERSIBLE FUR
Short, dense, black fur that can lie at any angle allows this mole to go forward or backward in its tunnels.

TUNNELING TOOLS



This mole's large front legs have powerful shoulder muscles and broad, outward-facing paws (above) with a strong, spadelike claw on each toe. Anchoring itself with its back feet, it uses its front legs to scoop soil sideways and back, pushing it up as molehills.

Condylura cristata

Star-nosed mole



Length 7–7½ in
(18–19 cm)
Tail 2½–3 in
(6–8 cm)
Weight 1½ oz
(45 g)
Social unit Variable
Status Least concern

Location E. Canada, N.E. USA



This mole is an expert swimmer. It has a long, sparse-haired, scaly tail, which enlarges in winter with fatty food reserves. In lifestyle and habits it resembles other moles, yet it is less solitary and tolerates meeting others of its kind. Its tunnels are about 1½ in (4 cm) in diameter and 2–24 in (5–60 cm) in depth.

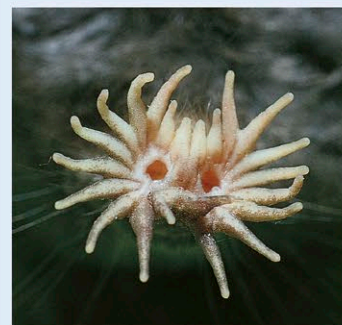
VARIED DIET

The star-nosed mole eats leeches, snails, small fish, and other aquatic prey, as well as soil animals.



dense, nearly-black fur

STAR-SHAPED NOSE



An unmistakable snout, with 22 pale, fleshy rays (tentacles) around the nostrils, allows the star-nosed mole to sniff and feel prey in water. It also forages for food among reeds, mosses, and other vegetation. As it hunts, the fleshy rays around its nose wiggle and flex in constant motion.

Pangolins

PHYLUM	Chordata
CLASS	Mammalia
ORDER	Pholidota
FAMILIES	1 (Manidae)
SPECIES	8

Similar in shape to armadillos and anteaters, pangolins are covered in overlapping scales, which act as armor and camouflage. Pangolins lack teeth: prey (ants and termites) is collected with the tongue, and powerful muscles

in the stomach "chew" the food. Pangolins are sought after for Chinese medicine, and this has led to all species receiving full CITES protection.



LONG TONGUE
Pangolins use their tongue, which can be extended as far as 10 in (25 cm), to gather ants and termites.

Manis pentadactyla

Chinese pangolin



Length 16–23 in
(40–58 cm)
Tail 10–15 in (25–38 cm)
Weight 5½–15 lb
(2.5–7 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Critically endangered

Location E. to S.E. Asia



Bony, pale or yellow-brown scales, up to 2 in (5 cm) across, cover all parts of the Chinese pangolin except for its snout, cheeks, throat, inner limbs, and belly.

When rolled into a ball, no soft areas are exposed. The thin tongue, as long as 16 in (40 cm), scoops up ants and termites. The strongly prehensile tail and long claws make this pangolin surprisingly agile in trees and a powerful burrower.



Manis temminckii

Ground pangolin

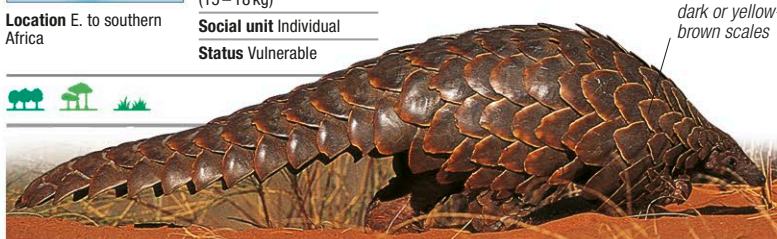


Length 18–21½ in
(45–55 cm)
Tail 16–20½ in
(40–52 cm)
Weight 33–40 lb
(15–18 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Vulnerable

Location E. to southern Africa



Similar in most respects to the Chinese pangolin (see left), this species rips open termite mounds and ant nests, both in trees and on the ground, with its large claws, and licks up the occupants. This pangolin shows little territorial behavior. The 1–2 young are born after a gestation of about 130–150 days.



dark or yellow-brown scales